

Final Project Information

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Final Project Assignment

1. Identify the background/motivation
2. Explain the optimization problem formulation
3. If the problem is **nonconvex NLP**:
 - a) analyze what approach do they use to solve the nonconvexity, e.g.
 - convert nonconvex problem to convex problem, ideally or approximately
 - use method that guarantees local optimality, e.g. Successive Convex Approximation (SCA), Block Coordinate Descent (BCD), etc.
 - b) Solve it **globally** by using **at least two global solvers** like Couenne, ANTIGONE, Baron, SCIP, etc. Use less number of variables if computationally more feasible, e.g. less number of users / nodes.
 - c) Solve it **locally** using **at least two frameworks**, e.g. Pyomo, GAMS, AMPL. For each framework: use **at least two local NLP solvers**, e.g. IPOPT, MINOS.
 - d) Instead of 3c), you can re-implement the local method proposed in the chosen paper, e.g. SCA, BCD, etc.
 - e) Compare the **global versus local implementation**, i.e. the method in 3c) or 3d) compare to 3b). Comparison in terms of **Big-O complexity, computation time, number of iterations to converge, optimal solution and optimal objective**

Final Project Assignment

4. Else if the problem is **MINLP/MILP**:
- analyze what approach do they use to solve the nonconvexity, e.g.
 - convert nonconvex problem to convex problem, ideally or approximately
 - use method that guarantees local optimality, e.g. Successive Convex Approximation (SCA), Block Coordinate Descent (BCD), etc.
 - Solve it **globally** by using **at least two** global solvers like Couenne, ANTIGONE, Baron, SCIP, etc. Use less number of variables if computationally more feasible, e.g. less number of users / nodes.
 - Solve it **locally** → see the slide *Solving MINLP with Nonconvex Function Locally* **or**
 - You must implement Branch and Bound for the integer variables manually**
 - then use **local NLP solvers** for the relaxed continuous variables. You must use these **two local solvers: IPOPT and MINOS**.
 - Instead of 4c), you can re-implement the local method proposed in the chosen paper, e.g. SCA, BCD, etc.
 - Compare the **global versus local implementation**, i.e. the method in 4c) or 4d) compare to 4b). Comparison in terms of **Big-O complexity, computation time, number of iterations to converge, optimal solution and optimal objective**

Final Project Assignment

5. Else if the problem is **convex programming**:
- a) analyze **why the function is convex and provide figure** to illustrate the convexity using a simpler version of the function, e.g. in 3D
 - b) analyze **why the constraints are convex and provide figure** to illustrate the convexity with a simpler version of the constraints, e.g. in 3D
 - c) Re-implement **manually** by selecting **at least two known** local methods for constrained problem: Primal-Dual Method, IPM-PD, IPM-LB, ALM, QPM
 - d) Compare the methods chosen in 5c) in terms of **Big-O complexity, computation time, number of iterations to converge, optimal solution and optimal objective**
 - e) Compare the results of 5d) with the results using **at least two frameworks**, e.g. CVXPY, Pyomo, GAMS, AMPL. For each framework, pick **at least two appropriate convex solvers**, e.g. IPOPT, MINOS, CPLEX, MOSEK, etc.

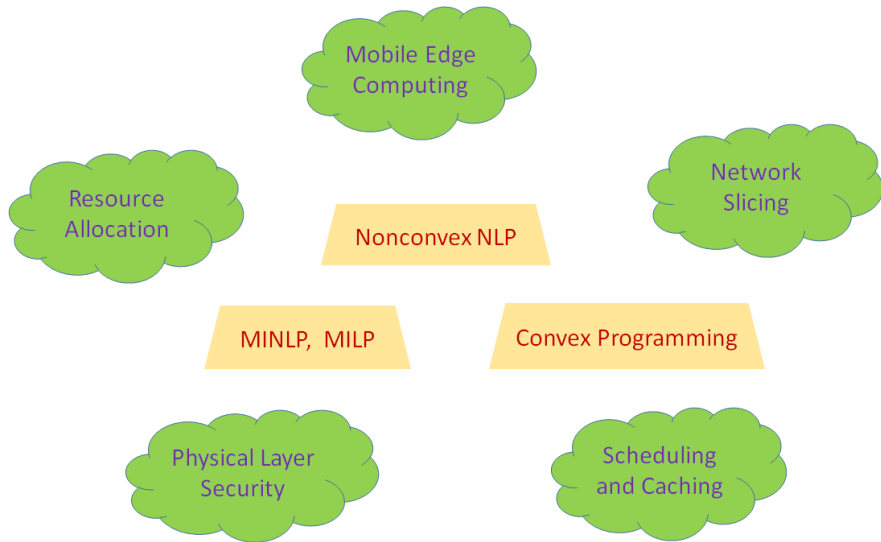
Final Project Format, Deadline, and Presentation

- Individual or a group of maximum 2 students
- Choose one paper from the list. Otherwise, students can propose their own paper, but [my approval is required](#). Paper selection until [Monday, May 11, 2026](#).
- Work on the project based on the slide *Final Project Assignment*
- Project report is in [Presentation Format](#)
- Report submission on Edunex. Deadline : [Thursday, June 11, 2026](#) (based on Final Exam schedule)
- Each individual or group deliver presentation on [Thursday, June 11, 2026](#).
- Presentation format:
 - 10 minutes presentation
 - 7-10 minutes Q/A
- Optional :
 - Shorter-version PPT for presentation
 - Longer-version PPT for submission via Edunex

Grading Aspects

1. All questions in slide "Final Project Assignment" shall be answered exactly as specified.
2. Accuracy of simulation results.
3. Ability in analyzing simulation results.
4. Ability in comparing between different methods and solvers.
5. Ability in explaining project outcomes.

Selected Papers List



Selected Papers List

- List of selected papers available at <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1f-BvtUdbuHh2AQWyjUfFpgxntVPlxKMO?usp=sharing>
- Each student/group is required to select a different paper.
- Confirm your paper selection by filling this sheet
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1iqYUIcuLhkn-R_kt8zAbueMZ9xp264J_VYugVWMRdsg/edit?usp=sharing
- Deadline: Monday, May 11, 2026